grew white, too, and her lip trembled. When she reached the bedside she said, "You, Tom! Tom, what's the matter with you?"

"Oh, auntie, I'm---"

"What's the matter with you? What is the matter with you, child?"

"Oh, auntie, my sore toe's dying!"

The old lady sank down into a chair and laughed a little, then cried a little, then did both together. This made her feel better and she said, "Tom, what a turn you did give me. Now you shut up that nonsense and climb out of this."

The groans stopped and the pain vanished from the toe. The boy felt a little foolish, and he said,"Aunt Polly, it seemed dying, and it hurt so I never minded my tooth at all."

"Your tooth, indeed! What's the matter with your tooth?"

"One of them is loose, and it aches perfectly awful."



"There, there, now, don't begin that groaning again. Open your mouth. Well. Your tooth is loose, but you're not going to die from that. Mary, get me a silk thread, and a chunk of fire out of the kitchen."

Tom said,"Oh, please, auntie, don't pull it out. It won't hurt any more. I wish I may never stir if it does. Please don't, auntie. I don't want to stay home from school."

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